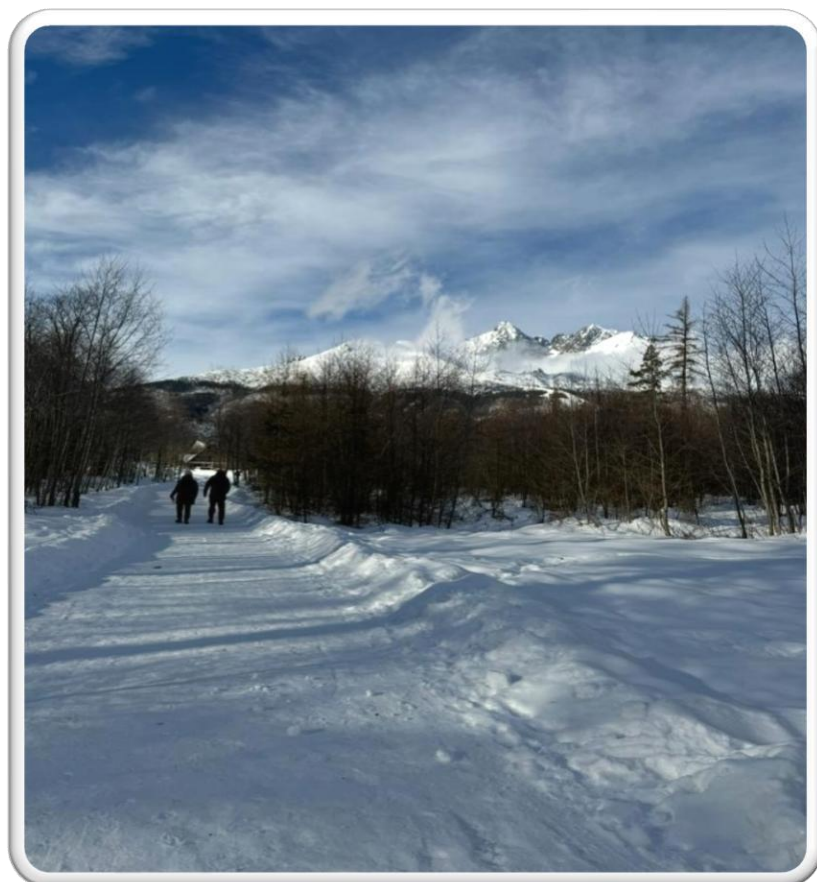




CAS

*Beyond the
classroom. Beyond
yourself.*

Juraj Babic
CAS Coordinator

CAS Handbook

IB DP Súkromné gymnázium Česká



CAS Handbook

IB Diploma Programme



School: Súkromné gymnázium Česká

Programme Duration: 18 months (DP1–DP2)

Coordinator: CAS Coordinator Juraj Babic, PhD.

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1 Course Description

Creativity, Activity, Service (CAS) is a **core component** of the IB Diploma Programme and is required for the award of the IB Diploma. CAS challenges students to:

- Develop personal growth
- Engage in experiential learning
- Reflect on meaningful experiences
- Contribute positively to the community
- Demonstrate initiative and perseverance



CAS is **not graded**, but students must successfully complete all requirements.



2 CAS Aims

CAS aims to develop students who:

- **Enjoy** and find significance in a range of CAS experiences
- **Purposefully reflect** upon their experiences
- **Identify** goals, **develop** strategies and **determine** further actions
- **Explore** new possibilities and **embrace** new challenges
- **Act** responsibly and ethically
- **Engage** with issues of global importance
- **Recognize** yourselves as members of local and global communities





3 CAS Strands

Creativity / Making something

Exploring and extending ideas leading to an original or interpretive product or performance.

Examples:



- Music, theatre, art exhibitions
- Digital design projects
- School magazine or podcast
- Event organization
- Coding / website creation

Activity / Breaking a sweat!

Physical exertion contributing to a healthy lifestyle. Examples:

- Team sports (football, basketball,
- Gym training
- Running club
- Dance competitions
- Hiking / outdoor expeditions





Service / Helping others

Collaborative and reciprocal engagement with the community in response to an authentic need.

Image 1: students organize
SWOP



Examples:

- Volunteering (Red Cross, charity events)
- Clothes SWOP (in the picture SG Ceska IB DP students)
- Tutoring younger students
- Environmental clean-up
- Fundraising projects
- Community awareness campaigns



4 Learning Outcomes (LO1–LO7)

Students must demonstrate achievement of the **seven CAS Learning Outcomes**:

1. *Identify own strengths and areas for growth*
2. *Demonstrate that challenges have been undertaken*
3. *Demonstrate how to initiate and plan a CAS experience*
4. *Show commitment and perseverance*
5. *Demonstrate collaborative skills*
6. *Engage with issues of global significance*
7. *Recognize and consider ethical implications of actions*

Evidence is documented in **ManageBac reflections and supervisor reviews**.



5 CAS Requirements

Requirement	Expectation
<i>Duration</i>	Minimum 18 months
<i>CAS Experiences</i>	Regular , sustained involvement
<i>Balance</i>	Creativity, Activity & Service across programme
<i>CAS Project</i>	At least one collaborative project (minimum 1 month)
<i>Reflections</i>	Ongoing, meaningful reflections
<i>Interviews</i>	3 formal CAS interviews (Initial, Midpoint, Final)
<i>Evidence</i>	Reflections, photos, supervisor/coordinator comments in ManageBac



6 CAS Project

- **Collaborative**
- Student-led
- Minimum **1 month** duration
- Demonstrates **planning** and **reflection**
- Addresses a **real** need or **creative** goal

Examples:

- Organizing a charity event
- Environmental awareness campaign
- School cultural festival
- Community workshop series
- Fundraising initiative



Image 2:

The IB DP students at Súkromné gymnázium Česká developed “raised beds” in the school backyard



7 Reflection in CAS

Reflection is central to CAS.

Students may reflect through:	Reflection must show:
Written reflections	Personal growth
Videos	Learning outcome development
Photo journals	Honest self-evaluation
Presentations	Ethical awareness
Interviews	
Creative responses	





Example of one of the students' **reflection process**:

Before starting

Before starting my mood board, I spent quite a lot of time thinking about how to realize my idea in the best way. I wanted to figure out how to organize everything on the poster and how to express the overall mood clearly. My goal was to make it interactive so that all students could mark their own moods.

During

I decided to make a sketch first and rely on it as a guide. I used colors that I personally associate with different moods and decided to add extra sections such as a “Weekly Summary” and “Tips,” so students could compare the class’s average mood and get some advice. During the process, I also realized that it’s not always necessary to strictly follow the original sketch — sometimes it’s better to trust your intuition. That’s why I added a “Class Energy Level” scale, where students can collectively mark the class’s energy throughout the day.

After

I really loved my classmates’ reactions. Our class truly needed some kind of activity that could bring us closer together. I realized how important it is to pay attention to each other’s emotional state. Even if people don’t always want to talk about their feelings, they can still express them through something like this.

This project helped me understand the value of emotional awareness and teamwork. I felt proud that my idea could make the class feel more connected and positive. I want to continue tracking our class’s mood and raise overall awareness about students’ emotional well-being.



8 Assessment & Completion

CAS is:

- Monitored continuously
- Evaluated as **Completed** / **Not Completed**
- Based on evidence of engagement and learning outcomes The CAS

Coordinator confirms completion before IB submission. Failure to complete CAS = No IB Diploma awarded.

What makes a CAS Experience?

- Interesting or fun for you
- Can fit **C** and/or **A** and/or **S** (see chapter 3)
- Expect to meet one or more of the LOs (see chapter 4)



THIS IS NOT CAS:

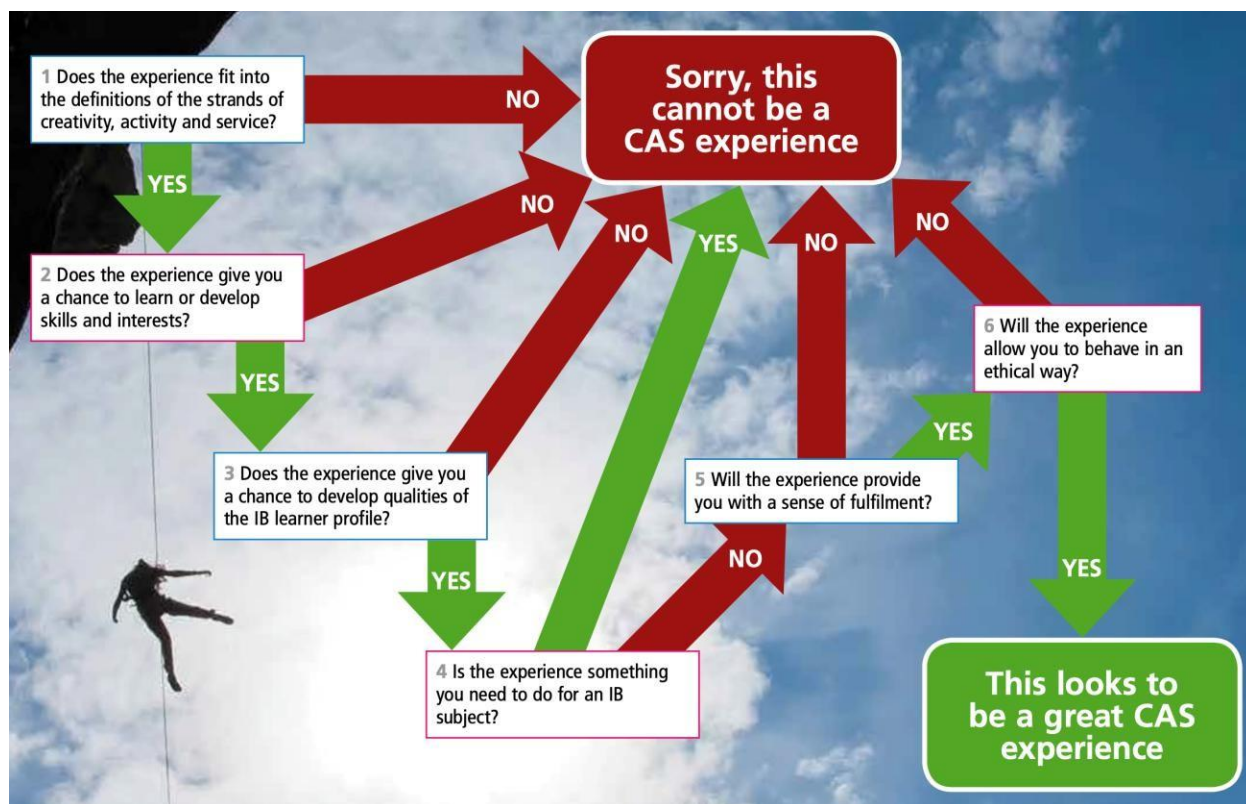


Image 3: Cannings, John. *IB Review*. November 2015

These are several instances of “**NOT CAS**” experience:

- paid work
- part of your academic programme
- dangerous
- unethical



9 Academic Integrity & Ethics

Students:

- ❖ ***demonstrate** honesty in reflections*
- ❖ *accurately **record** participation*
- ❖ ***respect** community partners*
- ❖ ***act** ethically and responsibly*



All documentation and evidence are recorded in **ManageBac**.



10 Timeline Overview

DP1

- **September:** CAS Introduction & goal setting
- **October:** Initial Interview (This interview is to **check that you have started** your CAS experiences, you are reflecting/evidencing and you understand the programme.)
- **Throughout year:** Regular experiences
- **May/June:** Midpoint Interview – defining your own balance (This interview **helps reflection** and **checks progress** towards meeting all of the requirements and learning outcomes.)
- Completion of CAS Project

DP2

- **July-December:** Continued CAS experiences
- **January-March:** Final Interview (This normally happens towards the end of the programme. This is a chance to **think back on what you have achieved** and to **check that you have finished**. It should almost be a chance to **celebrate** a job well done.)
- **March-April:** CAS completion confirmation



11 CAS Stages

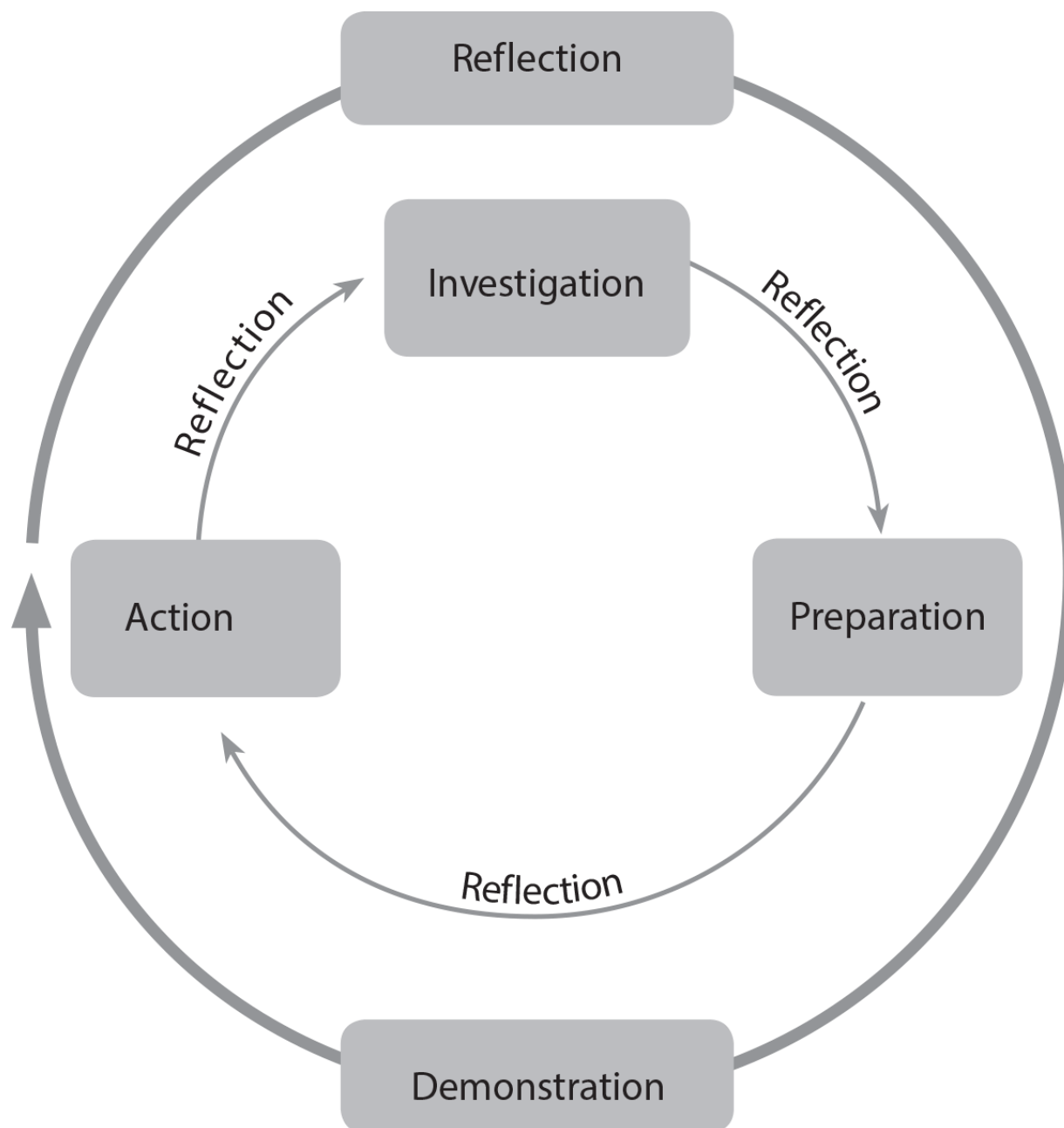


Image 4: *IB Diploma Programme Creativity, Activity, Service Guide* (page 16). March 2015



Sources

Diploma Programme Creativity, activity, service guide

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Images:

Images 1 and 2: IB DP CAS at Súkromné gymnázium, Česká 10, Bratislava, Slovakia Image 3:

Cannings, John. IB Review. November 2015

Image 4: IB Diploma Programme Creativity, Activity, Service Guide (page 16). March 2015